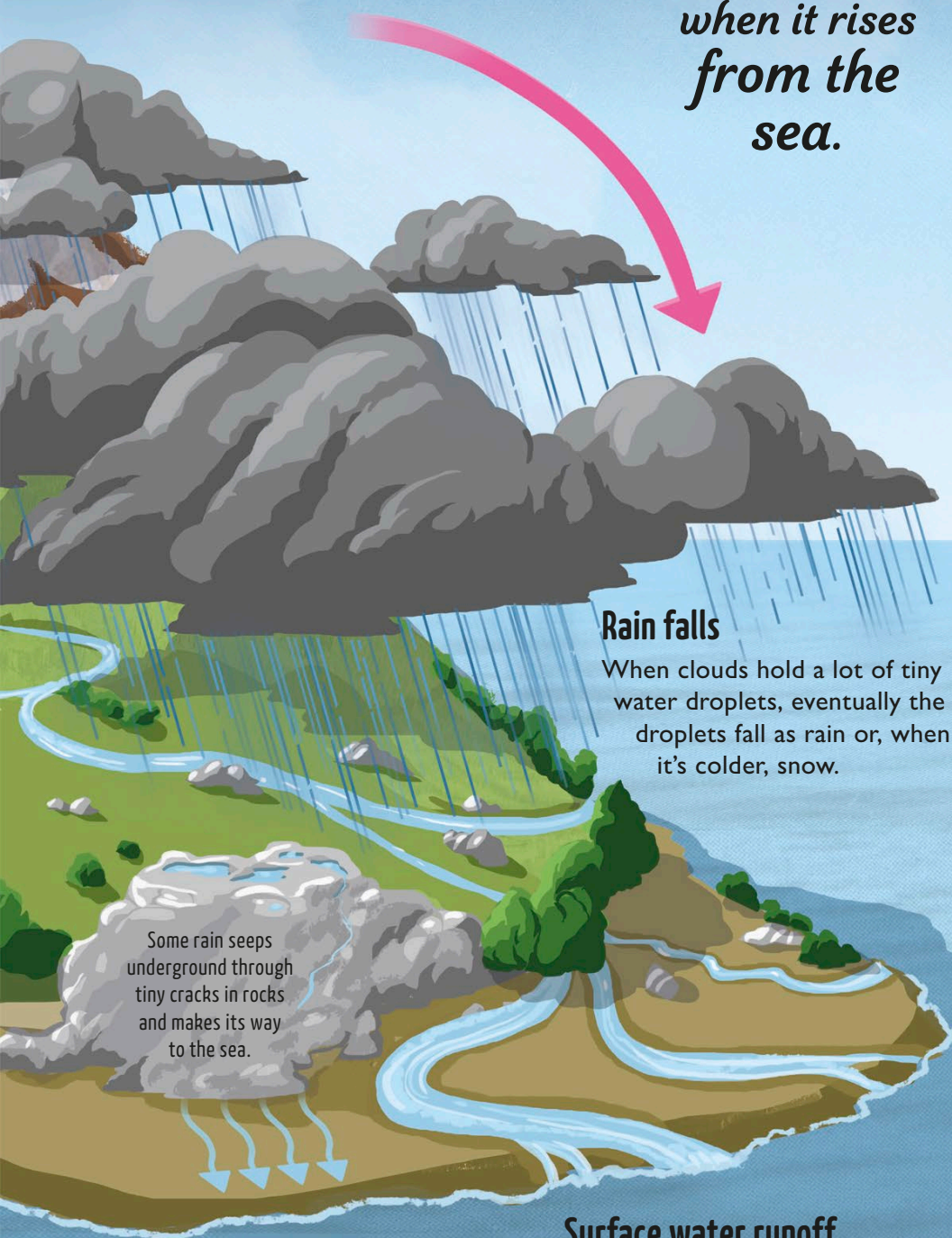


*Water loses
its saltiness
when it rises
from the
sea.*



Rain falls

When clouds hold a lot of tiny water droplets, eventually the droplets fall as rain or, when it's colder, snow.

Surface water runoff

The water from rain or melted snow that does not soak into the ground runs downhill over the surface of the land until it joins streams and rivers. It can still seep into the ground or evaporate, but most water eventually flows into the sea.

Fog Clouds don't always form up in the sky—they can also form when warm, moist air cools just above the ground or the sea. This is called fog.



Salt pans People collect salt from the sea by digging shallow pits by the shore and filling them with salty seawater. When the water evaporates, it leaves behind the salt. These pits are called salt pans.



Dry land There are some areas, such as deserts, that have very little rainfall. The driest place on Earth is the McMurdo Dry Valleys of Antarctica. Some parts haven't seen rain for nearly two million years.

